
Rail

Metro, light rail, conventional rail and high speed rail around Taipei — the lines, the trains that run them, the depots that keep them running, and the history that shaped all three.

Everything on rails: the Taipei Metro, New Taipei's light rail lines, the Taoyuan Airport MRT, and — eventually — the conventional TRA network and high speed rail where they serve the region. The section was renamed from "Train" because half of that list is not usefully described by the word.

Covered today: the Wenzhou Line in full — the line, both fleets, both depots, each of its stations, and the Matra dispute that shaped the system. Other lines, fleets and depots have entity pages that state their scope and what is still unverified, so that every named thing on this site has somewhere to link to.

Not yet covered, in order of intent: the Sanying Line (new, and written up ahead of the rest while its opening is still current), the remaining TRTC lines, New Taipei's light rail, TRA and THSR. Depth follows the Wenzhou pattern: one line finished properly at a time, not all lines thinly.

The network

All seven lines across three operators, with a geographic map drawn from official route geometry.

Stations

Every station with a page so far — generated from the same registry that draws the maps.

Lines

Route overviews, station lists, operating hours and service patterns.

Wenzhou Line

Taipei's driverless brown line — no cab, a front window you can stand at, and a rubber-tired guideway that climbs hills the rest of the network cannot.

Sanying Line

New Taipei's newest railway — a driverless elevated line to Sanxia and Yingge, open five weeks and still free to ride, written up here while every English source is still a machine translation.

Tamsui–Xinyi Line

The red line — the network's north–south spine, from the riverside at Tamsui through the core to Xiangshan, and the oldest right-of-way on the system.

Songshan–Xindian Line

The green line — Songshan to Xindian through the west of the core, with the network's short branch to Xiaobitan.

Zhonghe–Xinlu Line

The orange line — a Y-shaped route whose two northern arms to Luzhou and Huilong share one southern trunk through Zhonghe.

Bannan Line

The blue line — the east–west trunk through the main station, and the corridor the rest of the network is measured against.

Circular Line

The yellow line — New Taipei's orbital, crossing the radial lines rather than feeding the core, and the network's first driverless steel-wheel operation.

Danhai LRT

New Taipei's first light rail — street-running trams serving the Tamsui new town, with a second phase under construction.

Ankeng LRT

The second New Taipei light rail line — a valley feeder into the Xindian corridor.

Taoyuan Airport MRT

The purple express-and-commuter line from Taipei Main Station to the airport and on into Taoyuan — a different operator, a different fare system, and the network's only express/local pattern.

Rolling Stock

Train fleets — builders, technical specifications, formations and where each type runs.

VAL256

The French fleet that opened the network in 1996 — and spent eighteen months in a depot having its brain replaced while the line it built ran without it.

Innovia APM 256 (C370)

Not a VAL, and not descended from one — a Canadian people mover built to fit a French railway, because the alternative was two incompatible halves of one line.

C301

The fleet that opened the high-capacity network — Kawasaki-built trains for the Tamsui corridor, since re-equipped with new traction.

C321

Siemens trains for the Bannan corridor — a fleet whose body-shell story says something about how specifications get enforced.

C341

The fleet the city did not buy — a small Siemens batch procured by a civil contractor, and a procurement story nobody has told in English.

C371

The workhorse of the network's middle generation — and, by the account to be verified here, the first metro EMU manufactured in Taiwan.

C381

The newest Kawasaki generation — built for the Songshan and Xinyi extensions, with a family resemblance to the C371 it grew from.

Depots

Stabling and maintenance facilities — location, capacity, and the lines and fleets they serve.

Muzha Depot

Where the network started — the first depot Taipei ever built for a metro, and demoted in 2009 from the whole of the system's engineering capability to the junior of two.

Neihu Depot

The line's main workshop — named after a district it is not in, and joined to the running line at the opposite end from the station that shares its name.

Beitou Depot

The network's first construction site and its principal depot — where the high-capacity system began, and where new fleets are still commissioned first.

Xindian Depot

The green line's depot — with a metro branch line climbing through the middle of it.

Xinzhuang Depot

The orange line's depot, built on the grounds of the Losheng Sanatorium — the most contested piece of land in the network's history.

Tucheng Depot

The Bannan Line's western depot.

Nangang Depot

The Bannan Line's eastern depot.

Luzhou Depot

The orange line's northern depot, at the end of the Luzhou arm.

History

How the railway came to be the way it is — the contracts, disputes and decisions whose consequences are still running.

The Matra dispute

Two disputes thirteen years apart, usually told as one — the test-track fires an engineering change explains, the seventeen-year lawsuit Matra won, and the walkout that taught Taipei how to buy its next railway.

Systems

The technology layer — signalling, power, guideway and automation — and why Taipei runs several of each.

Three numbering systems on one line

Every Wenhua station has two numbers. On the southern half they run in opposite directions, and the northern half uses a different series again — because the line was built as two projects and a station was added to one of them late.

Operators

Who actually runs what — TRTC, New Taipei Metro, Taoyuan Metro, and eventually TRA and THSR.

Taipei Rapid Transit Corporation

The company that runs the Taipei Metro — city-owned, and distinct from the government department that builds the lines it operates.

New Taipei Metro Corporation

New Taipei City's own operator — light rail, the Circular Line, and now the Sanying Line.

Taoyuan Metro Corporation

The airport line's operator — a third city's company running the region's only express service.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operator TRTC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-05; source last updated 2020-01-31. Provenance.